PROSCIUTTO, GOAT CHEESE AND SPINACH FILLING

INGREDIENTS

128 g	Prosciutto, in a single piece
116 g	Ricotta
114 g	Spinach leaves, lightly packed
168 g	Fresh goat cheese
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
18 g	Egg yolk
quantity not given	Salt

METHOD

1. Chill the meat grinder and all its dies for at least an hour before you grind anything.
2. Cut the prosciutto into cubes of ½ to 1 inch and give them about 15 minutes in the freezer. They want to be colder than a refrigerator gets them, without freezing.
3. Fit the grinder with the larger of two dies, or the middle one of three, and run the prosciutto through twice. Set it aside.
4. Pulse the ricotta in a food processor just to a glossy, frosting-smooth state and no further. Over-processing breaks it. Scrape it into a bowl.
5. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil over high heat. Set up a salted ice bath with a colander standing in it.
6. Boil the spinach about a minute, until tender but still bright green, then move it into the ice bath to stop it cooking.
7. Drain the spinach, turn it out onto a kitchen towel and squeeze the water out, then chop it finely.
8. Combine the whipped ricotta, goat cheese, ground prosciutto, spinach and parmigiano in a bowl and mix until everything is evenly integrated. Taste and adjust with salt. It wants to taste properly seasoned.
9. Stir the egg yolk through and refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

NOTES

Everything that touches the prosciutto stays cold. Chilled grinder, chilled dies, 15 minutes in the freezer for the cubes, or the fat smears instead of cutting.
Grind the prosciutto twice. One pass leaves it too coarse to pipe.
Ricotta is doing structural work, not just bulking the mix. It covers for the chalkiness of goat cheese and tempers the tang.
Whip the ricotta only to a frosting-like sheen. Past that it breaks.
Squeeze the blanched spinach properly dry before chopping it, otherwise the water loosens the filling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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